📚 SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 21

Web-to-Case in Salesforce

Automatically Create Cases from Your Website — Complete Support Automation Guide

- 🌐 What is Web-to-Case?
- ⚙️ How the Support Workflow Operates
- 🛠️ Setup & Enable Web-to-Case
- 📝 Generate Web-to-Case HTML Form
- 🌍 Embed on Website & Live Testing
- ⚠️ Daily Limits & Best Practices

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL
21 of Series	~16.5 Minutes	Beginner to Intermediate

KEY FOCUS

Support Automation

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SECTION 1

Introduction & Context

⏱ 0:00 – 0:45

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In the previous episode, we learned how **Web-to-Lead** automatically captures incoming sales leads when prospects fill out a web form.

However, sales leads only represent potential new business. What about **existing customers** who encounter an issue, need product troubleshooting, or request warranty support? Do customer service representatives manually type up every incoming ticket? **No!**

Salesforce provides a specialized customer support counterpart called **Web-to-Case**, which creates Case tickets directly in Salesforce the moment a customer submits a support inquiry on your website.

SECTION 2

🌐 What is Web-to-Case & Why Do Businesses Need It?

⏱ 0:45 – 4:00

💻 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY: THE BROKEN LAPTOP KEYBOARD

Imagine you bought a brand-new laptop, and after a couple of weeks the keyboard stops working. You visit the brand's official support website, open the **"Submit a Ticket"** page, and enter your Contact Name, Email, Phone, Issue Subject ("Keyboard not responding"), and a detailed description. As soon as you hit **Submit**, a Case record is created instantly inside the manufacturer's Salesforce org for the technician team!

📌 DEFINITION

Web-to-Case is a built-in Salesforce Service Cloud feature that allows companies to collect customer support requests directly from an online website form and immediately convert them into Case records.

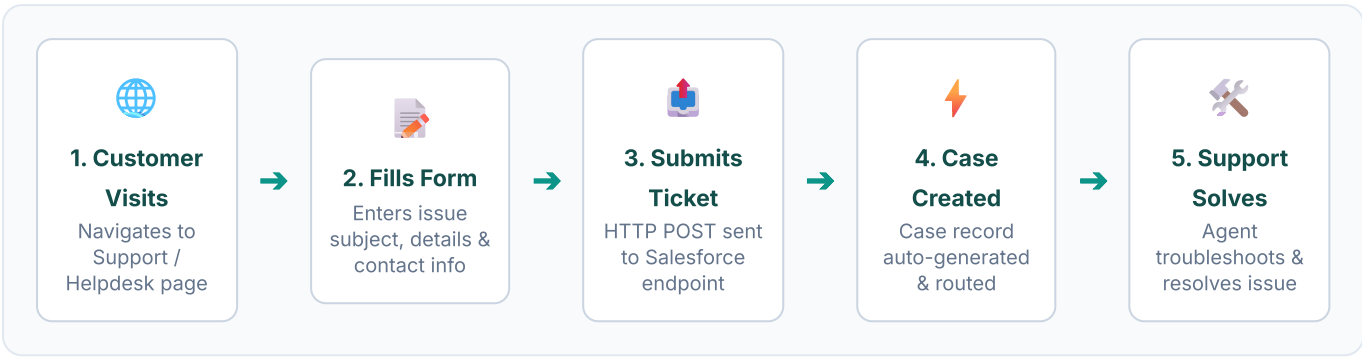
⚖️ Manual Support Intake vs. Automated Web-to-Case

Aspect	❌ Without Web-to-Case (Manual)	✅ With Web-to-Case (Automated)
Ticket Creation	Agents manually copy details from emails or chat into Salesforce	Created automatically in real time upon web form submission
Turnaround Time	Support requests can sit unread in inboxes for hours or days	Instantaneous assignment; SLA countdown starts immediately
Risk of Lost Tickets	High probability of missed emails, duplicates, or forgotten requests	Zero missed tickets; every customer submission is logged in CRM
Agent Productivity	Support reps waste significant time doing repetitive data entry	Agents spend 100% of their bandwidth solving customer problems

SECTION 3

How Web-to-Case Works (Process Lifecycle)

⏱ 4:00 – 5:30



💡 **AUTO-LINKING CUSTOMER CONTACTS**

When a customer enters an email address in the Web-to-Case form, Salesforce checks existing Contacts. If an exact email match is found, Salesforce automatically links the new Case to that Contact and their corresponding Account record!

SECTION 4

Prerequisites Checklist

⏱ 5:30 – 6:30

- **Salesforce Edition & Org:** Developer Edition, Sandbox, Enterprise, or Unlimited org with the **Case Object** active.
- **System Administrator Access:** Permissions to access Setup, edit Web-to-Case settings, and view HTML generators.
- **Configured Case Fields:** Standard or custom Case fields (e.g., Subject, Description, Priority, Type) ready for public intake.
- **External Web Page / Host:** An HTML file, landing page, customer portal, or CMS (WordPress, Webflow) to host the generated form.
- **Return URL (Thank You Page):** The destination landing page where customers land after successfully submitting a case.

SECTIONS 5 & 6 — HANDS-ON SETUP

Enabling Web-to-Case & Generating the HTML Form

⏱ 6:30 – 10:30

Part A: Enabling Web-to-Case in Salesforce

1. Click the ⚙️ **Setup** gear icon in the top right corner.
2. In the **Quick Find** box, search for `Web-to-Case` and select it.
3. Click **Edit**.
4. Check the box to **Enable Web-to-Case**.
5. (Optional) Select a **Default Case Owner** (User or Support Queue) in case assignment rules don't match.
6. (Optional) Choose a **Default Response Template** to send instant auto-confirmation emails to customers.
7. Click **Save**.

Part B: Generating the Web-to-Case HTML Form

1. On the Web-to-Case page in Setup, click **Generate Web-to-Case HTML**.
2. Select the fields to display on the public form:
   - `Contact Name` (First & Last Name)
   - `Email` & `Phone`
   - `Subject` (Brief title of the issue)
   - `Description` (Detailed problem breakdown)
7. Enter the **Return URL** (e.g., `https://yourcompany.com/case-submitted.html`).

8. (Recommended) Enable **Include reCAPTCHA in HTML** to prevent bot spam tickets.
9. Click **Generate**.
10. Copy the generated raw HTML code block to your clipboard.

SECTION 7

🌍 Adding the Form to Website & Live Testing

⏱ 10:30 – 12:30

1. Open your code editor (e.g., VS Code or Notepad) and create a file named `support.html`.
2. Paste the copied Salesforce Web-to-Case HTML code into the file and save it.
3. Open `support.html` in any web browser (Chrome, Edge, etc.).
4. Fill out the support form with sample details:
   - Name: *Alex Johnson*
   - Email: *alex@example.com*
   - Subject: *Keyboard stopped working on Model X*
   - Description: *Spacebar and enter keys do not respond after update.*
9. Click **Submit**. Confirm that your browser redirects to your Return URL.
10. Switch back to Salesforce, open the **Cases** tab from App Launcher.
11. Select **All Open Cases** or refresh **Recently Viewed**. Verify that the new Case appears with all filled details! 🎉

> 💡 **DESIGN TIP**
>
> The generated HTML is clean and unstyled so your frontend web development team can apply CSS styles, responsive layouts, or embed the inputs inside your existing support portal framework.

SECTION 8 — DEEP DIVE COMPARISON

⚖️ Web-to-Lead vs. Web-to-Case

⏱ Concept Check

Feature	🌐 Web-to-Lead (Episode 20)	🛠️ Web-to-Case (Episode 21)
Target Object	Lead Object	Case Object
Primary Audience	Prospective buyers / Inbound prospects	Existing customers experiencing issues
Salesforce Cloud	Sales Cloud	Service Cloud
Default Daily Limit	Up to **500 leads per day**	Up to **5,000 cases per day**
Typical Fields	Company, Lead Source, Phone, Title	Subject, Description, Priority, Type
Internal Team	Sales Representatives / BDRs	Customer Support / Helpdesk Agents

SECTION 9

⚠️ Limitations & Best Practices

⏱ 12:30 – 15:30

⚠️ Salesforce Web-to-Case Limitations

- **Case Records Only:** Web-to-Case can only create Case records. It cannot create or update custom objects directly.
- **Daily Limit (5,000 Cases):** Standard Salesforce orgs support a maximum of **5,000 cases per 24-hour period**. Additional requests are queued and processed later when capacity is freed.
- **No File Attachments by Default:** Standard out-of-the-box Web-to-Case forms do not support customer file uploads (such as error screenshots or log files).
- **Complex Logic Requires Customization:** Advanced multi-step support processes require Salesforce Flows, Apex, or external REST API integrations.

💡 Recommended Best Practices for Admins

- **Keep the Form Simple:** Ask only for essential details needed to triage the issue. Lengthy forms frustrate users.
- **Always Implement reCAPTCHA:** Prevent spam bots from flooding your support queues with automated fake cases.
- **Configure Case Assignment Rules:** Automatically route cases to specialized queues (e.g., Billing, Hardware, Software Support) based on the Subject or Type.
- **Enable Auto-Response Rules:** Instantly email the customer with a Case Number confirming receipt and setting resolution expectations.
- **End-to-End Testing:** Verify case creation, email notifications, and routing in a Sandbox before deploying to production.
- **Monitor Open Queue Volumes:** Regularly review incoming Case volume in dashboard views to maintain healthy SLAs.

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 21

01

Web-to-Case automatically captures online customer support inquiries and creates Case records inside Salesforce in real time.

02

Eliminates tedious manual ticket creation, accelerates first-contact resolution, and ensures no customer ticket falls through the cracks.

03

If the submitted email matches an existing Contact, Salesforce automatically links the Case to that Contact and their parent Account.

04

Setup is 100% declarative: Enable Web-to-Case → Select fields → Enter Return URL → Generate HTML form code.

05

Standard governor limits allow up to **5,000 cases per 24 hours** (10x the limit of Web-to-Lead's 500/day).

06

Combine with **Case Assignment Rules**, **Queues**, and **Auto-Response Rules** for a complete automated helpdesk.

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 22

Next Core Salesforce Admin Feature

Stay tuned as we continue building practical, job-ready Salesforce administration and automation skills!